Vantage Sauna Co. — Business Plan (Canada)

Nov 1, 2026 · @jake

Executive Summary

Vantage Sauna Co. turns the most underused space in a building, its roof, into its most-loved amenity: a factory-built, all-electric rooftop sauna suite, installed in days and run through our own booking software and service plan. We launch in Vancouver and Victoria in 2027 and add Toronto in 2028. To get there we are raising about **C$2.15M of equity** (C$150,000 of pre-seed now and a **C$2.0M seed round by the end of March 2027**) plus a **C$350,000 government-backed equipment loan**. That pays for Canadian engineering and certification, a demo Lodge, a Fraser Valley workshop and the first 19 installed buildings by the end of 2028.

The problem. Rental towers, hotels and condos compete on amenities, but pools and spa floors cost millions, take years and need space the building does not have. Roofs sit empty. New rental towers are struggling to fill: 59% of the GTHA's 2025 rental completions were still unleased at year end. Meanwhile Vancouver alone has about 20 sauna studios charging C$24–55 a visit.

The product. Three models, all prefabricated in the Fraser Valley and all electric:

- **Perch**, 4–6 seats, from C$99,000 installed.
- **Lodge**, 8–10 seats with a changing vestibule, indoor shower and weatherproof lockers, from C$179,000 installed.
- **Summit**, 12–14 seats with a changing room, cold plunge, outdoor shower and terrace, from C$329,000 installed.

In every hot room both bench tiers run wall to wall along the back wall and face a full-length, privacy-tinted glass front, so every seat has a view out. Heaters carry a Canadian mark (cETLus, cULus or CSA) and run on 208 V. In BC the steel base is bolted to the structure with engineered anchors, flashed by a roofer, to meet seismic rules. Prices exclude GST, PST and HST.

The business model. Buildings buy outright (50% deposit, 40% at delivery, 10% at commissioning) or lease through Vantage Flex from C$2,150 a month. Every building then pays for **Vantage Care** (service, C$450–1,150 a month) and **Vantage Access** (booking, smart-lock access and analytics, C$300 a month). Hardware earns about 42% gross margin at steady state. Recurring revenue of about C$10,048 per building a year earns 63%.

The market. The three cities hold about 4,770 hotels, large condo projects and rental towers. We estimate about 1,140 are suitable today: about C$207M of hardware at our C$181,500 average contract, plus about C$11.5M a year of recurring revenue. The base plan needs 122 of them, about 11%, by 2031.

The plan. 5 installs in 2027, 14 in 2028, 24 in 2029, 34 in 2030 and 45 in 2031. Revenue grows from C$0.78M to C$9.16M, EBITDA turns positive in 2029 and reaches C$1.33M in 2031, and cash never falls below C$0.84M. The base case needs no Series A.

The team. Founded by Jacob [Last name], Founder and CEO. The first hires in 2027 are a head of engineering and product (P.Eng.), a sales and partnerships lead for hotels and rental owners, and an operations and project manager.

The Opportunity

Canadian rental towers, hotels and condos need an amenity that sets them apart, and the roof is the one place most of them can still add one in weeks rather than years.

New rental towers are fighting for tenants. In the GTHA, two-thirds of rental buildings completed since 2000 offered incentives in Q4 2025, and 35% offered two months free (Urbanation, Jan 2026). In Metro Vancouver, buildings with 200+ units ran 11.5% vacancy in October 2025, and stock built since mid-2022 ran 14.8% (CMHC Rental Market Survey 2025). An owner in that position needs a reason for tenants to choose the building.

Hotels cannot add rooms, so they need more revenue per guest. Vancouver's hotel stock has not grown since 2002 (Hotel Management Network, Jun 2025). Its hotels ran 78.4% occupancy at a C$284 average daily rate in 2025, the highest of any major Canadian market (CoStar via Hospitality Net). Fairmont Pacific Rim already sells C$40 Nordic sessions on its sixth-floor pool deck (Fairmont).

The expensive options are gone. A rooftop pool or a spa floor needs structural work, plumbing, mechanical space and years of permits. Most owners have no amenity left to add that residents and guests will talk about.

The roof is empty. Most large flat-roofed buildings carry a mechanical zone and nothing else. It is the most underused space in the building, and it has the best view.

Sauna has gone mainstream in Canada. Metro Vancouver has about 20 circuit-sauna venues (The Peak, Aug 2026). Toronto's Othership charges C$58 a class (Narcity, Mar 2026), and Victoria has HAVN's floating sauna in the Inner Harbour (Tourism Victoria). Regular users already pay C$130–280 a month for memberships (Scout Magazine, Oct 2025).

Nobody sells it as a product. An owner who wants a rooftop sauna today hires an architect, a structural engineer, a sauna builder, an electrician, a roofer and a crane company. The only commercial rooftop sauna we found in Canada is at the Hampton Inn & Suites in downtown Vancouver, known from travel listings (Destination Vancouver). Vantage packages the whole job into one contract and one from-price.

	Custom rooftop build today	Vantage
Time from decision to first session	Often a year or more of design, bids and permits	12–20 weeks (Summit 16–26 weeks), including permits and owner votes
Parties the owner manages	Architect, engineer, sauna builder, electrician, roofer, crane company	One contract

	Custom rooftop build today	Vantage
Price certainty	Known at bid, after design fees	Fixed from-price before the site visit; site preparation quoted separately
Seismic and roof attachment	Designed from scratch each time	Standard base: engineered, flashed anchors in BC; ballasted where allowed in Toronto
Electrical approval	Assembled per project	Canadian-marked 208 V heaters; a transformer kit for 600 V buildings
Operation after install	The owner's problem	Vantage Access booking and Vantage Care service

The Product

Vantage sells three rooftop sauna suites built on one construction system, so every unit is factory-built in the Fraser Valley, priced before the site visit and engineered to Canadian codes.

Model	Seats	Exterior footprint (W × D × H)	Interior rooms	Heater	Dry weight	Installed price (from, before tax)
Perch	4–6	2.4 × 3.0 × 2.9 m	Sauna 2.2 × 2.2 m, ceiling 2.3 m; 0.6 m covered entry porch	1 × 10.5 kW, 208 V, cETLus, cULus or CSA marked	\~2,300 kg	C$99,000
Lodge	8–10	3.0 × 4.8 × 3.0 m	Sauna 2.8 × 2.8 m, ceiling 2.4 m; changing vestibule 2.8 × 1.6 m with an indoor shower; weatherproof exterior lockers by the entry	1 × 18 kW, 208 V, Canadian-marked	\~4,500 kg	C$179,000
Summit	12–14	3.6 × 7.2 × 3.1 m plus a 3.6 × 3.6 m terrace	Sauna 3.4 × 4.0 m, ceiling 2.4 m; changing room 3.4 × 2.8 m with lockers; cold plunge 1,200 L (regulated as a pool); outdoor shower	2 × 12 kW, 208 V, Canadian-marked	\~8,000 kg plus \~1,900 kg plunge when filled	C$329,000

Every seat faces the view. In every hot room both bench tiers run wall to wall along the back wall and face a full-length, privacy-tinted glass front on the outside wall. The two short side walls are solid wood and carry the door and the heater corner. Seats are bench places at 600 mm: the drawn layouts give 5, 7 and 11 places (7, 9 and 13 at 550 mm). At the comfort guideline of 3 m³ per person the rooms hold 4, 6 and 11. Heaters are sized at about 1 kW per m³ plus an allowance for the glass, which gives effective heated volumes of about 16, 25 and 37 m³.

What the price includes. Perch at C$99,000 is suite hardware C$56,000, engineering, permits and drawings C$10,000, delivery and install C$20,500, electrical connection C$7,500, and commissioning, training and launch C$5,000. Lodge at C$179,000 is C$105,500, C$14,000, C$33,500, C$11,500 and C$14,500. Summit at C$329,000 is C$201,000, C$21,000, C$58,000, C$22,500 (electrical and water) and C$26,500. A delivered-only commercial cabin from Fritz Tiny Homes in Alberta starts at C$77,850 (Fritz Tiny Homes). The Perch's extra C$21,000 or so pays for the engineering, the lift, the electrical connection, commissioning and the software.

Site preparation is quoted separately. BC seismic anchors and roof flashing C$8,000–15,000. A 600 V to 208Y/120 V transformer kit C$10,000–25,000 where the building has only 347/600 V service. Structural reinforcement where the roof is not rated for occupancy (4.8 kPa). Street-use and crane permits for module lifts.

Add-ons. Lodge cold plunge C$34,500, terrace decking and privacy screens C$12,500–34,000, lighting scene pack C$5,000, towel and robe station C$3,000. Contracts average about C$12,000 of add-ons at a 45% margin. All prices exclude GST, PST and HST.

Construction system (shared by all models).

- Base: hot-dip galvanized steel frame on adjustable feet and rubber load-spreading pads that carry the module to the roof's beams and columns. In Vancouver and Victoria (seismic category SC4) friction may not resist earthquake forces, so the frame is bolted to the structure with 4–8 engineered anchors, flashed by a roofer, and ballast is kept to a minimum. In Toronto a ballasted base with no roof penetrations can still pass where the site is SC1 or SC2 and the wind checks pass. Designed for occupied roofs rated 4.8 kPa (NBC, BCBC and OBC Table 4.1.5.3).
- Walls, outside to in: 20 mm thermally modified ash or pine cladding, 25 mm ventilated cavity, breathable membrane, 12 mm fibre-cement sheathing, 90 mm non-combustible mineral wool, aluminium-foil vapour barrier rated to 120 °C, 22 mm batten gap, 15 mm thermo-aspen interior panelling. About 185 mm in total. Towers of noncombustible construction get a noncombustible wood-look cladding option (or a CAN/ULC-S134 test) and fire-retardant or tested ceiling boards with a flame-spread rating of 25 or less.
- Roof: standing-seam steel on a 3° mono-pitch with an integrated gutter to the roof drain. The module roof is designed for 2.0 kPa of snow plus drift (the code roof snow load is 1.64 kPa in Vancouver and 1.12 kPa in Toronto).
- Glazing: the whole outside wall of the hot room is a double-glazed tempered unit with a privacy-tinted reflective bronze outer pane and a low-iron inner pane, in a thermally broken aluminium frame. By day bathers see out and the roof sees a dark pane. At night the effect reverses, so the night lighting scene keeps the hot room dim; an interior blind is optional.
- Heater: commercial electric, Canadian-marked (cETLus, cULus or CSA) to CSA C22.2 No. 164-18, rated for 208 V three-phase. The controller has schedules, an over-temperature cut-off, a door sensor and a hard-wired 1-hour timer with no override, as Ontario's Rule 62-222 requires. Buildings with only 600 V service get the transformer kit.
- Interior: thermo-aspen benches in two tiers along the back wall, side wall to side wall, facing the glass. The upper bench is 1,150 mm from the floor and 700 mm deep, with the ceiling 1,150–1,250 mm above it. The lower bench is 700 mm high and 500 mm deep, with a 350 mm step by the door. The far end of the lower tier is a transfer section 465 mm high and 1,070 mm long, kept as best practice. The door is an 850 mm clear (900 mm leaf) outward-swinging glass door in the near side wall, and the Lodge and Summit hot rooms have a 1,500 mm turning space (CSA B651). Non-slip composite

floor over aluminium grating with a drain; mechanical ventilation at 9–12 L/s per person; dimmable 2700 K LED scenes.

- Fire and safety: sprinkler-ready module with a high-temperature head, a horn and strobe tied to the building's fire alarm, a Bluetooth/NFC smart lock tied to Vantage Access, an occupancy sensor, an emergency stop, a 90 °C interior cap, safety signage and a first-aid and drinking-water station.

Delivery. Perch and Lodge ship by default as flat-pack panel kits that fit a standard elevator: no panel larger than 2.0 × 1.1 m and no piece over 120 kg. They are assembled on the roof, which avoids crane permits and street closures downtown. Summit ships as a craneable module, and Perch or Lodge can too where a staging street exists. Kits for Toronto travel by truck from the Fraser Valley. On-site time is 1–2 days (Perch), 2–3 days (Lodge) and 4–6 days (Summit). Contract to first session takes 12–20 weeks for Perch and Lodge and 16–26 weeks for Summit, including permits, owner votes and any pool permit.

Software and service. Vantage Access (C$300 a month per building) handles booking, smart-lock access, session timers within the 1-hour hard cut-off, usage analytics and, for hotels, paid-session pricing. It runs on a white-label platform at launch. Vantage Care (C$450, C$700 or C$1,150 a month by model) covers quarterly inspections, heater stones, bench refinishing, parts, 24-hour support and water-quality logging for any plunge.

How It Works

From signed contract to first session takes 12–20 weeks for Perch and Lodge and 16–26 weeks for Summit, in seven steps that Vantage runs end to end. Most of that time is owner votes and permits; the factory build runs in parallel.

1. **Site assessment (week 0).** A desktop check of the roof plans, the electrical service (120/208 V or 347/600 V), the access route and the site's seismic category, then a site visit. Output: a model recommendation and a firm installed price, with site preparation quoted separately.
2. **Owner approval (weeks 1–8).** A rental or hotel owner signs directly. A BC strata needs a 3/4 vote of the votes cast at a general meeting, and a further 3/4 vote to fund it from a special levy or the contingency reserve fund. An Ontario condo board can proceed with notice to owners when the cost is under 10% of the annual budget; above that, owners of 66⅔% of all units must vote yes. We supply the information-session kit and sample resolutions.
3. **Engineering and drawings (weeks 2–4).** A structural engineer licensed in BC (EGBC) or Ontario (PEO) designs the anchors or ballast and checks the 4.8 kPa occupied-roof load, snow drift, wind (NBC 4.1.7) and seismic forces. Our electrical engineer designs the 208 V feed or the transformer kit.
4. **Permits (weeks 4–12).** A development permit where Vancouver needs one, the building permit, the electrical permit (City of Vancouver, City of Victoria, or an ESA notification in Ontario), plumbing, a health-authority permit for any cold plunge, and a street-use permit for a crane lift. Toronto must decide a complete application within 20 business days (30 for high buildings); Vancouver's median for commercial renovation permits was 32 days in mid-2024.
5. **Factory build (4–6 weeks, in parallel).** Panel fabrication, heater and controls fit-out, glazing, and a heat and ventilation test in the Fraser Valley workshop before anything ships.
6. **Install (1–6 days on site).** An elevator carry and on-roof assembly for a flat-pack, or one crane lift for a module. In BC a roofer flashes the anchors. Set the base, place the suite, connect power and drain.
7. **Commissioning, training and launch.** Electrical inspection, heat tests, Vantage Access set up for residents or guests, staff training and a launch event. Vantage Care starts the same day.

What the building provides. A clear roof area (about 5 × 6 m for Perch, 6 × 8 m for Lodge and 8 × 12 m for Summit including the terrace). A barrier-free route to the roof, which Ontario requires for rooftop amenity spaces. A roof exit and guards at least 1,070 mm high. An electrical service with capacity, or a quoted upgrade. A roof drain within reach, and an elevator or crane position for delivery.

Market Analysis

The three launch cities hold about 4,770 hotels, large condo projects and rental towers. We estimate about 1,140 are suitable today, worth about C$207M of hardware at our C$181,500 average contract plus about C$11.5M a year of recurring revenue. The base plan needs 122 of them, about 11%, by 2031. Figures were read on the linked pages on 1 November 2026; the full fact base, with confidence ratings, is in `06-research/canada-market-research.md`.

Segment	Sourced universe, three cities	Suitable (our filter, est.)	Source
Hotels	376 hotels: City of Vancouver 79 (13,003 rooms), Richmond 21 branded, City of Toronto 139 (26,928 rooms), Mississauga and Markham 65 branded, Victoria 72 (5,566 rooms)	71 (upscale or better, roof and owner pass, plus new builds)	Horwath HTL, Canada Hotels & Chains Report 2026
Condos and strata	\~3,140 projects (est.): \~1,200 of 100+ units in Metro Vancouver, \~1,700 in the Toronto CMA, \~60 in Victoria plus \~120 of 50–99 units. CMHC counts 316,469, 530,838 and 30,768 condo apartments	772 (roof space, governance and finances pass)	CMHC Rental Market Survey 2025
Rental towers and business apartments	\~1,250 towers (est.): Toronto's registry lists 891 rental buildings of 10+ storeys and 100+ units (710 private), plus \~145 elsewhere in the CMA, \~190 in Metro Vancouver and \~25 in Victoria	300 (private owners, plus new towers due 2027–2031)	City of Toronto apartment building registry, CMHC
Total	\~4,770 buildings	\~1,140 buildings (\~C$207M of hardware)	

City	Suitable buildings (est.)	Base plan, buildings by 2031	Share of suitable
Toronto (City and GTA), from 2028	697	69	10%
Vancouver (Metro), from 2027	397	44	11%
Victoria (CRD), from 2027	49	9	18%
Total	1,143	122	11%

Who decides, and how fast. A rental tower or hotel has one owner who decides, so the sales cycle is 2–4 months. Toronto's 710 private rental towers were mostly built in 1960–84 and belong to REITs, pension

funds and private landlords that buy for whole portfolios. Condos take 4–9 months. In BC a significant change to common property needs a 3/4 vote of the votes cast; a special levy needs 3/4; reserve-fund spending needs 3/4, or a majority if the depreciation report recommends it (Strata Property Act s. 71). In Ontario, owners of 66⅔% of all units must vote yes if the cost exceeds 10% of the annual budget, the board can proceed with notice below that, and the reserve fund cannot pay for new amenities (Condominium Act, 1998, s. 97). A Lodge, at C$202,270 with HST, stays under the 10% line in Toronto condos of roughly 300 units or more (est.).

Why buildings will buy.

- Rental owners are paying to fill towers. GTHA asking rents averaged C$2,916 a month but C$2,565 after incentives (Urbanation, Jan 2026). In a 300-unit tower that gap costs about C$1.26M a year; a suite that closed a tenth of it would be worth about C$126,000 a year, so a Lodge would pay back in under two years (est.).
- Hotels can earn from it. A 300-room downtown Vancouver hotel at 80% occupancy has about 430 guests a night. If 3% book a C$40 session, that is about C$190,000 a year; Vantage's 35% revenue share is about C$66,000, well above the C$24,000 annual minimum (est.).
- Residents already pay for it. In a 300-unit tower where 10% of residents would otherwise pay a C$150 monthly membership, a building suite delivers about C$4,500 a month of value, more than the C$3,850 Lodge Flex lease (est.).

Why now.

- The hotel pipeline is the largest in Canada: Toronto has 71 projects (11,665 rooms) and Vancouver 45 (8,562 rooms) (Lodging Econometrics Q3 2026).
- Rental supply is at a 40-year high. The GTHA started 9,821 purpose-built rentals in 2025 with 27,815 under construction (Urbanation), and Vancouver approved 10,277 rental homes in 2025 (Daily Hive, Apr 2026). We brief the architects of these projects in 2027 for 2029–2031 deliveries.
- Thermal bathing is scaling: Tevah opened a 60-person sauna in downtown Vancouver in December 2025 (BC Business, Nov 2025), and Therme plans 14 saunas at Ontario Place for 2029 (Spa Business, Jul 2025).

Launch markets. Vancouver and Victoria first, in 2027. They share one province, one strata law and one building code, and their hotels run full: Vancouver 78.4% occupancy at a C$284 average rate in 2025 (downtown 80.5% at C$342, Destination Canada), and Greater Victoria 79.9% from January to August 2025 (Destination Greater Victoria). Toronto follows in 2028 as the volume market, with about 60% of the suitable buildings; downtown hotels ran 75.3% at C$350 in 2025 (CBRE via Ontario Data Catalogue).

Open questions we will close at the pilots. No Canadian survey prices a sauna premium in rents, condo values or hotel rates. The hotel class split by city, the condo project counts (derived from CMHC unit counts) and the rental-tower counts for Vancouver and Victoria are our estimates. We will measure lease-up, rents and usage at the first buildings.

Business Model and Pricing

Vantage earns about 42% gross margin on each installed suite at steady state, then about C$10,048 a year per building at a 63% margin from service and software for as long as the sauna is on the roof. By the end of 2031 the 122 installed buildings bring in about C$1.2M of recurring revenue a year.

Three ways to buy.

- **Purchase** (primary). 50% deposit at contract, 40% at delivery, 10% at commissioning. Deposits pay for materials before each build. Care and Access are billed monthly.
- **Vantage Flex.** An 84-month lease through a Canadian equipment-finance partner, with Care and Access included. The partner pays Vantage in full at install, and the building books an operating cost instead of capital. Site preparation is billed separately.
- **Hotel revenue-share pilot.** Up to three lighthouse hotels: no upfront cost, Vantage takes 35% of session revenue over a five-year term with a C$2,000 monthly minimum. Vancouver hotels already sell C$40 sessions (Fairmont Pacific Rim). The purpose is flagship references, not scale.

Model	Purchase, installed (from, before tax)	Vantage Flex, per month (84 months)	Vantage Care, per month
Perch	C$99,000	C$2,150	C$450
Lodge	C$179,000	C$3,850	C$700
Summit	C$329,000	C$6,800	C$1,150

Vantage Access is C$300 a month per building on every model. Prices are from-prices in Canadian dollars; site conditions set the final quote.

Sales tax. Prices exclude GST, PST and HST. Hotels and short-stay operators recover GST/HST, so they compare pre-tax prices. Condo corporations and long-term rental landlords generally cannot, so we quote them with tax shown: a Perch costs a Toronto condo C$111,870 with 13% HST. In BC, whether 7% PST applies to the whole contract depends on whether the suite counts as equipment or as an improvement to the building. We will get a written BC PST ruling before quoting in BC.

Unit economics per building. On the planned mix (40% Perch, 45% Lodge, 15% Summit) plus about C$12,000 of add-ons, the blended contract is C$181,500, with about C$104,900 of cost and C$76,600 of gross profit (42%) at steady state. Cost of goods covers materials, factory labour, freight, the install crew, the electrical subcontractor and permit drawings. Recurring revenue after attach rates (Care 85%, Access 90%) is C$10,048 a year, with about C$6,330 of gross profit. Early units cost more (+20% in 2027, +8% in

2028, +3% in 2029), pilot contracts carry a 15% discount in 2027 and 5% in 2028, and Toronto installs add about C$7,500 of freight. A 2027 pilot Lodge, for example, costs C$124,500 to build and sells for C$152,150.

Why the recurring layer matters. It turns a one-off sale into a relationship with the owner, gives us usage data for the next sale in the portfolio, and makes the installed base an asset: a building on Vantage Access and Care calls us first when the next roof comes up.

Go-to-Market Strategy

We sell first to owners who decide alone (rental towers and hotels), prove the product with a demo Lodge and a lighthouse rooftop in Vancouver, and add Toronto in 2028 once the first BC buildings are live and referenceable.

Segments, in priority order.

1. **Purpose-built rental towers and business or serviced apartments.** One decision-maker under lease-up pressure. The motive is faster lease-up, fewer concessions and tenant retention. Purchase or Vantage Flex. Furnished-apartment operators such as Corporate Stays and Blueground lease units inside these towers, so they are a channel and a demand signal rather than separate roofs.
2. **Upscale and lifestyle hotels.** The owner or brand wellness team buys a paid guest experience and a rooftop story. Purchase, Flex or the revenue-share pilot (up to three hotels).
3. **Condos and strata.** Slower, but the largest pool. The BC playbook is one general meeting with two 3/4 resolutions: approve the change, and fund it. The Ontario playbook keeps a Perch or Lodge under 10% of the annual budget in larger towers, so the board can proceed with notice. Both come with information-session kits and sample resolutions.
4. **Developers of new rental and hotel projects.** We brief architects in 2027 for deliveries in 2029–2031.

Channels. Direct sales to owners and asset managers; property-management firms and strata managers as referral partners; architects and developers who specify Vantage into new projects; a demo Lodge in the Fraser Valley workshop; and a lighthouse rooftop in Vancouver.

Sales process. A site-assessment request or an outbound approach to a target list, a desktop check of the roof plans and electrical service, a site visit, a firm proposal, owner approval, and a contract with a 50% deposit. We plan on 2–4 months for rentals and hotels and 4–9 months for condos.

Pilot programme. Before the seed closes we aim for three signed letters of intent, at least one from a hotel and one from a rental owner. In 2027 we install five paid pilot suites at a 15% discount, in exchange for case studies, usage data and references. The goal is three lighthouse references by the end of 2027.

City expansion. Vancouver and Victoria in 2027, served from the Fraser Valley workshop. Toronto business development starts in Q2 2028, a Toronto operations lead joins in 2029 and a GTA staging bay opens in 2031. Flat-pack kits travel to Toronto by truck, at about C$7,500 of freight per install. Before the first Toronto sale we get an Ontario legal opinion on condo approvals and an ESA interpretation of the 1-hour timer rule.

Competition and Differentiation

No company in Canada sells a rooftop sauna as a finished, priced and serviced product. The owner's alternatives are a custom project, a residential kit or a delivered-only cabin, or sending residents and guests to a sauna club.

What the owner needs	Custom build (architect, sauna builder, trades)	Canadian sauna makers (Fritz Tiny Homes, SaunaFin, Nootka, Dundalk LeisureCraft)	Social-sauna clubs (Othership, Tevah, HAVN)	Vantage
Price	Bespoke; one Vancouver builder lists jobs of C$2,000–120,000	Barrels and kits C$8,000–15,000; commercial cabins from C$77,850, delivered only	C$35–58 a session, per user	From C$99,000 installed
Rooftop structural and seismic engineering	Bespoke each time	No	Not applicable	Yes, a standard base stamped per site
Fixed installed price before the site visit	No	Unit price only, no install	Not applicable	Yes
Canadian-marked commercial heater and permit package	Assembled per project	Rarely	Not applicable	Yes
Booking, access control and 1-hour session timers	No	No	Own venues only	Yes, Vantage Access
Service for the life of the unit	No	Warranty only	Not applicable	Yes, Vantage Care
Amenity owned by the building	Yes	Yes	No	Yes

Custom builds deliver a good sauna at a high and uncertain price. Local builders such as Vancouver Sauna and SaunaFin (Concord, Ontario) work inside existing spas and amenity floors, not on roofs. They are our competition for flagship hotel projects, and we will lose some of those on bespoke design.

Canadian sauna makers build good barrels and cabins for backyards and cottages. Nootka's cedar barrels sell for C$7,950–9,950 (Nootka Saunas), and Fritz Tiny Homes' commercial cabins start at C$77,850,

delivered only (Fritz Tiny Homes). None offers rooftop engineering, seismic anchors, a Canadian-marked commercial heater package, installation or operating software. They are the most likely to follow us onto roofs, and the most likely acquirers. A cost-cutting strata council will compare us with a C$10,000 barrel. Our answer is commercial duty: a commercial heater, Canadian certification, an accessible bench, a smart lock and a service plan.

Social-sauna clubs are the hotels' real alternative. Othership charges C$58 a class in Toronto, Tevah runs a 60-person sauna in downtown Vancouver, and HAVN plans a Vancouver barge for mid-2027 after its Victoria harbour site (Daily Hive, Nov 2025). They prove the demand we sell against. A building with its own suite offers that experience without the trip or the membership.

Our defence is not a patent. It is the rooftop and seismic engineering kit, the Canadian code and permit package, the heater and module certification, the installed base on Vantage Access and Care, and references from the first buildings. Building them takes us most of 2027, and a follower would have to do the same.

Operations and Manufacturing

Vantage builds in a leased workshop in the Fraser Valley, buys heaters, glass and steel from established suppliers, and installs with its own crews and local roofing, electrical and crane partners.

Facility. About 4,000 sq ft of light-industrial space in Langley or Abbotsford at about C$22 per sq ft a year gross, leased from April 2027 (C$66,000 in 2027). The fit-out costs about C$180,000: 600 V three-phase power and a panel (C$35,000), an overhead hoist and racking (C$25,000), dust extraction (C$15,000), a panel saw, a used CNC router and finishing gear (C$70,000), an install kit with a stair-climber and lifting gear (C$20,000), and IT and a shop office (C$15,000). A used 16-ft box truck with a liftgate costs about C$55,000. We move to about 8,000 sq ft in Q2 2029 and add a GTA staging bay in 2031.

Supply chain. Steel base frames from a Canadian fabricator; wall and roof panels made in our workshop; thermally modified cladding and thermo-aspen interiors from Nordic and North American mills; tinted insulated glass from a regional supplier; and Canadian-marked commercial heaters, ideally of EU origin. Sauna heaters enter Canada duty-free from the EU, the UK, the US and Mexico. A 25% surtax on imported steel derivative goods (including prefabricated structures) and Canada's counter-tariffs on some US goods make Canadian steel and EU-made heaters the cheaper path. We collect the certificate number for every heater before we order, and every component gets a second source as volume grows.

Build quality. Every suite completes a factory checklist and a heat and ventilation test before it ships. Moisture, temperature and heater-cycle data from the test are stored against the unit's serial number and feed the Care plan. From 2029 we certify the workshop and panel kit to CSA A277. A certified module is deemed to comply with the Ontario Building Code, and in BC it spares inspectors from opening up concealed work on site.

Install logistics. Perch and Lodge ship as flat-pack kits of panels no larger than 2.0 × 1.1 m, with no piece over 120 kg. Crews carry them up the elevator, using a stair-climber where needed, and assemble them on the roof in one to three days. Summit ships as a module and needs a crane and a street-use permit, so we sell it to roofs with a staging street; a downtown lift can add C$15,000–35,000. In BC a roofing partner flashes the seismic anchors so the roof warranty stays intact. Toronto kits travel by truck from the Fraser Valley.

Capacity plan. The base plan rises from 5 installs in 2027 to 45 in 2031; the yearly figures by city are in the Financial Plan. Install labour sits in cost of goods, and we add a Toronto crew as Toronto installs start in 2028.

After install. Vantage Care visits each building every quarter: inspections, heater stones, bench refinishing, parts and 24-hour support, plus water-quality logging for any plunge. Vantage Access gives the building

manager usage, booking and fault data, and the same data tells us when a heater element or sensor is due before it fails.

Engineering, Safety and Compliance

Every Vantage install is designed by a structural engineer licensed in the province, uses a Canadian-marked electric heater in a non-combustible envelope, and is permitted by the city before it goes on the roof. The governing codes are the BC Building Code 2024 in Victoria, the Vancouver Building By-law 2025 in Vancouver and the Ontario Building Code 2024 in Toronto, all built on the National Building Code 2020.

Structure. The galvanized steel base carries the module's weight (about 2,300 kg for Perch, 4,500 kg for Lodge and 8,000 kg for Summit, plus about 1,900 kg for a filled plunge) through adjustable feet and pads to the roof's beams and columns. Suites are designed for occupied roofs rated 4.8 kPa (Table 4.1.5.3); roofs rated lower are reinforced as site preparation. Vancouver and Victoria are in seismic category SC4, and the codes say friction may not resist earthquake forces on rooftop components. In BC the frame is therefore bolted to the structure with 4–8 engineered anchors that a roofer flashes. In Toronto a ballasted base with no roof penetrations can still pass where the site is SC1 or SC2 and the wind checks pass. The module roof takes 2.0 kPa of snow plus drift, and wind is checked to NBC 4.1.7.

Fire. All-electric heating with no combustion on the roof. Walls use non-combustible mineral wool and fibre-cement sheathing behind the cladding, and the roof is standing-seam steel. Most towers are of noncombustible construction, so for them we offer a noncombustible wood-look cladding (or a CAN/ULC-S134 test of the wood assembly) and ceiling boards that are fire-retardant treated or tested to a flame-spread rating of 25 or less. The module is sprinkler-ready with a high-temperature head, and a horn and strobe inside are tied to the building's fire alarm. The interior is capped at 90 °C. A sauna enclosure is not on the codes' list of rooftop structures left out of the storey count, so we get a code consultant's opinion before selling into 4–6 storey wood-frame buildings.

Electrical. Heaters carry a Canadian mark (cETLus, cULus or CSA) to CSA C22.2 No. 164-18; a US-only mark is not accepted. They are rated for 208 V three-phase, because a 240 V heater on 208 V gives only about 75% of its output. Buildings with only 347/600 V service get a 600 V to 208Y/120 V transformer kit. Wiring follows the Canadian Electrical Code, adopted as the BC Electrical Code and the Ontario Electrical Safety Code. Ontario's Rule 62-222 requires a timed cut-off of at most one hour with no override, so every Vantage heater has a hard-wired 1-hour timer and the app cannot extend a session. Electrical permits come from the City of Vancouver and the City of Victoria; in Ontario a licensed contractor files an ESA notification.

People safety. Smart-lock access only for booked users; an occupancy sensor; an emergency stop that cuts the heater and alerts the building; exterior signage on temperature, hydration and session length; a drinking-water and first-aid station; non-slip flooring, a 350 mm bench step and a guarded heater. The building sets session limits and age rules in Vantage Access.

Accessibility. Every suite has an 850 mm clear door (900 mm leaf) and a level or ramped entry. The Lodge and Summit hot rooms have a 1,500 mm turning space (CSA B651), and controls sit within reach. The lower bench has a transfer section, kept as best practice. The barrier-free route to the roof is the building's responsibility; Ontario requires one for rooftop amenity spaces. In BC an indoor shower must be accessible, which is an open design item for the Lodge vestibule.

Cold plunge. The Summit plunge and the Lodge add-on are regulated as pools in both provinces: a commercial pool that needs construction and operating permits in BC, and a Class B public cold plunge pool in Ontario. Each plunge has chlorine or bromine dosing with logging, a handrail, a clock, signs, an emergency stop and a health notice, and its permit costs are priced into the quote.

Permits. Building, electrical and plumbing permits; a development permit where Vancouver requires one; a health-authority permit for any plunge; and street-use permits for crane lifts. We keep one reusable permit drawing set for Vancouver, Victoria and Toronto, so each review starts from the same package.

Insurance and liability. Vantage carries general liability, products and completed-operations cover and an installation floater, and names the building owner as additional insured for the install. The building's own liability cover extends to the amenity in the same way as a gym or pool, and Vantage Care keeps the inspection record that insurers ask for.

Certification path. Before the first install we will have Canadian-marked heaters and an electrical field-evaluation path for the module. We then seek a listing of the whole module (heater, controls and room) to CSA C22.2 No. 164, plus UL 875 for export, and certify the workshop to CSA A277. The 2027 budget holds C$70,000 for Canadian certification and C$40,000 for heat, fire and load testing.

Marketing and Brand

Vantage markets one idea, "the amenity above everything", to a small number of owners, asset managers, hotel general managers and strata councils, and lets every installed roof do the rest of the work.

Positioning. Vantage is a building-products company with a hospitality finish: engineered, certified and serviced like elevator equipment, designed and photographed like a boutique hotel. The voice is warm, precise and Nordic-modern. The visual identity is Ember orange on Charcoal and Birch, set in Fraunces and Inter, with the glowing tinted glass front of the suite at dusk as the signature image.

Messages by audience.

- To rental owners and asset managers: the amenity that fills a new tower and keeps tenants, on space you already own, live in 12–20 weeks.
- To hotels: a rooftop thermal session guests pay for, as Fairmont Pacific Rim's C$40 sessions already show, with a revenue-share option for the first three hotels.
- To strata councils and condo boards: one vote, one fixed price, an information-session kit for owners, and service and booking handled for you.
- To investors: a prefab product with about 42% hardware margins, recurring revenue on every unit, and no Canadian competitor selling a turnkey rooftop suite.

Tactics.

1. **The demo Lodge** in the Fraser Valley workshop and a **lighthouse rooftop** in Vancouver: owner and asset-manager evenings, strata-manager tours and architect visits. Nobody buys a sauna from a brochure.
2. **Launch events** at every install, run with the building, with residents' photographs feeding social channels. Each roof becomes its own campaign.
3. **Case studies with data:** booking rates, peak hours, and resident and guest ratings from Vantage Access, published with the owner's consent.
4. **Industry events:** two a year to start, at rental-housing and hotel conferences in BC and Ontario.
5. **Referral programme** for property managers, strata managers and architects who introduce a signed building.
6. **Search and content** for the few people a year who search for a rooftop sauna for their building, with the website's site-assessment request as the single call to action.

Budget. Marketing of C$60,000 in 2027 (sales kit, case-study shoots and two industry events), rising to C$120,000 in 2028 and C$240,000 in 2031. The demo Lodge is budgeted separately, at C$110,000.

Team and Hiring Plan

Vantage starts with a founder and three hires who cover engineering, sales to building owners and project delivery, and grows to 11 people outside the workshop and install crews by 2031.

Founder. Jacob [Last name], Founder and CEO. [Add two sentences: what you have built, sold or run before, and why rooftop saunas.] The founder is unpaid until the seed closes, then costs C$95,000 a year fully loaded.

First hires (2027).

- **Head of Engineering and Product, P.Eng.** (January 2027, C$145,000 loaded): owns the design for Canada, seismic anchorage, certification, the demo Lodge and the workshop.
- **Sales and Partnerships Lead** (April 2027, C$120,000): hotels and rental owners; owns the pilot programme and the first references.
- **Operations and Project Manager** (July 2027, C$125,000): permits, installs and service.
- Install crews and workshop staff are hired as volume requires and sit in cost of goods.

Advisers. From day one, on fixed fees: a startup lawyer, an accountant who files SR&ED claims, a BC structural engineer (P.Eng.) for seismic anchorage, an electrical engineer for the 208 V and 600 V designs, and a code consultant; an insurance broker before the demo and a customs broker before the first orders. From the first quarter of 2027, for equity rather than salary: a hotel operator, a rental-tower asset manager and a strata manager. [Add names as they confirm.]

Year	Non-COGS headcount (year end)	Roles added	Non-COGS payroll (C$M)
2027	4	Founder and CEO; head of engineering and product; sales and partnerships lead; operations and project manager	0.39
2028	6	Toronto business development (Q2); marketing and customer success (Q3)	0.63
2029	8	Toronto operations lead (Q1); design engineer (Q2)	0.95
2030	10	Sales representative, Vancouver; finance and admin	1.21
2031	11	Sales representative, Toronto	1.40

Salaries rise 3% a year in the model. Workshop staff and install crews are not in this table; their cost sits in cost of goods.

Financial Plan

Revenue grows from C$0.78M in 2027 to C$9.16M in 2031, EBITDA turns positive in 2029 and reaches C$1.33M in 2031, and quarter-end cash never falls below C$0.84M. All figures come from the quarterly cash model behind the plan (`05-financial-model/`), in Canadian dollars and before sales tax.

> *Chart in the editable original (claude.ai). Data: Base plan, BRIEF.md section 5 (quarterly cash model, 05-financial-model/) · C$ · 2027–2031.*

Hardware is 89% of 2031 revenue, but the recurring line is what the installed base compounds: 122 buildings at about C$10,048 a year is about C$1.2M of annual recurring revenue entering 2032.

> *Chart in the editable original (claude.ai). Data: Base plan, BRIEF.md section 5 (quarterly cash model, 05-financial-model/) · C$ · 2027–2031.*

C$ millions unless stated	2027	2028	2029	2030	2031
Installs (Vancouver / Victoria / Toronto)	5 (4/1/0)	14 (7/1/6)	24 (9/2/13)	34 (11/2/21)	45 (13/3/29)
Installed base, year end	5	19	43	77	122
Total revenue (hardware plus recurring)	0.78	2.53	4.66	6.76	9.16
Gross profit	0.15	0.86	1.86	2.82	3.85
Gross margin	19.0%	33.8%	39.8%	41.7%	42.1%
Operating expenses	1.05	1.18	1.70	2.13	2.53
EBITDA	−0.90	−0.32	+0.15	+0.69	+1.33
Net income, after depreciation, interest, IRAP and SR&ED	−0.93	−0.25	+0.08	+0.63	+1.26
Capex	0.35	0.04	0.12	0.08	0.08
Cash at year end, with the C$2.0M seed and C$0.35M loan	1.19	0.97	1.02	1.69	2.68

Key assumptions. Product mix 40% Perch, 45% Lodge, 15% Summit with C$12,000 of add-ons, giving a blended contract of C$181,500 at about 42% gross margin at steady state. Early units cost 20% more in 2027, 8% more in 2028 and 3% more in 2029, and pilot prices carry a 15% discount in 2027 and 5% in 2028. Recurring revenue is C$10,048 per building per year (Care at 85% attach, Access at 90%) at a 63% margin. Operating expenses from 2027 to 2031, in C$ millions: non-COGS payroll 0.39 to 1.40; facility 0.066 to 0.236; marketing 0.06 to 0.24; engineering, certification and testing 0.26 in 2027, then 0.08 to 0.11; G&A (insurance, legal, accounting, software, travel) 0.19 to 0.30; booking-platform set-up 0.06 in 2027; and sales commission at 3% of hardware revenue. Imported parts are converted at C$1.40 per US dollar and C$1.56 per euro (Bank of Canada, October 2026). Customers pay 50% at contract, so deposits fund materials and working capital is a source of cash. As a Canadian-controlled private corporation, Vantage keeps the 35% refundable SR&ED credit and the small-business tax rate (11% in BC, 11.2% in Ontario).

Funding need. On a quarterly view, cash falls to its lowest point of C$0.84M in Q2 2029, about six months of costs, before installs carry the company. Without the seed the company would run out of money in the first quarter of 2027. The full answer, with sources, uses and startup costs, is in the next section.

Unit economics. Each building returns about C$76,600 of gross profit at install at steady state and about C$6,330 a year after that, or about C$121,000 over seven years. In 2031, marketing and sales commission come to about C$10,800 per install, before sales salaries.

Downside case. If Vantage reaches only the research's conservative 81 buildings by 2031 (5, 10, 16, 23 and 28 installs a year), EBITDA is only about break-even by 2031. The C$2.0M seed still lasts through 2029; after that we would delay the 2029–2030 hires.

Funding Requirement and Use of Funds

Vantage needs about **C$2.15M of equity plus a C$350,000 government-backed loan**: C$150,000 of pre-seed now and a **C$2.0M seed round closing by the end of March 2027** (range C$1.75–2.25M, as a SAFE or a priced round, valuation to be agreed). About C$150,000 of NRC IRAP support and SR&ED refunds of about C$45,000–80,000 a year from 2028 add non-dilutive money. The base case needs no Series A; an optional growth round in 2029 could speed up Toronto.

Where the money comes from.

Source	Amount	When	How
Pre-seed: founder, friends and family, Futurpreneur	C$150,000	Now to March 2027	Futurpreneur lends up to C$75,000 (with BDC) if the founder is 18–39; the rest from savings or family, on a SAFE
Seed round (equity)	C$2,000,000 (range 1.75–2.25M)	Close by the end of Q1 2027	BC angels through a registered Eligible Business Corporation, who get a 30% BC tax credit; proptech and real-estate funds (Alate Partners, myVentures, Golden Ventures, BC venture capital corporations); strategic real-estate owners and hotel groups
Canada Small Business Financing Program loan	C$350,000	Q2 2027	Through our bank, for the workshop fit-out, tools, truck and demo unit (equipment and leaseholds are capped at C$500,000); prime + 3%, with prime at 4.70% from 29 October 2026; repaid over five years
NRC IRAP	About C$150,000	Q3 2027 to Q3 2028	Agreed with an Industrial Technology Advisor before the seed closes; funds part of the engineering salaries
SR&ED refundable tax credit	About C$45,000–80,000 a year	From Q3 2028	35% back on qualifying engineering, claimed with each tax return
Customer deposits	50% of each contract	At signing	Pays for materials before each build

Why C$2.0M of seed. Customers' 50% deposits pay for materials, so the money we raise mainly funds the team, engineering, certification and the workshop until installs cover them. The seed size sets how much cushion is left at the low point in Q2 2029.

Seed size	Lowest cash (quarter end)	When	Cash at end of 2031	Verdict
None (pre-seed and loan only)	−C$1.16M	Q2 2029	C$0.68M	Not possible: the company runs out of money in the first quarter of 2027
C$1.5M	C$0.34M	Q2 2029	C$2.18M	Too thin: about two months of 2029 costs
C$2.0M (recommended)	**C$0.84M**	**Q2 2029**	**C$2.68M**	**About six months of costs in reserve at the low point**
C$2.5M	C$1.34M	Q2 2029	C$3.18M	Comfortable; lets us hire for Toronto a year earlier

In the downside case (81 buildings by 2031) a C$2.0M seed still lasts through 2029, which is why we are not raising the minimum.

Sources and uses, 2027–2028. Over the first two years the company spends about C$2.73M and earns about C$1.00M of gross profit from its first 19 installs, leaving C$0.97M of cash at the end of 2028.

> *Chart in the editable original (claude.ai). Data: 08-launch-plan/launch-plan.md section 1.3 and BRIEF.md section 6 · C$ · 2027–2028.*

Startup costs. The pre-seed and the 2027 budget break down as follows; the itemised version is in `08-launch-plan/launch-plan.md`.

Budget	C$	What it pays for
Pre-seed, Nov 2026 to Mar 2027	150,000	Incorporation, trademark and tax set-up 13,000; concept engineering for seismic anchorage and electrical 26,000; code consultant 9,000; bench-and-glass mock-up 22,000; customer discovery and letters of intent 12,000; brand, renderings and pitch materials 15,000; seed-round legal 15,000; starter insurance and software 5,000; contingency 33,000
One-time launch costs, 2027	665,000	Engineering, certification and testing 260,000; demo Lodge 110,000; workshop fit-out and tools 180,000; truck 55,000; booking and smart-lock platform 60,000. The equipment loan covers 350,000 of this
Running costs, 2027	751,000	Team 392,500; workshop lease 66,000; marketing 60,000; insurance 40,000; legal 50,000; accounting and tax 30,000; software and IT 15,000; travel 30,000; office and miscellaneous 25,000; sales commission 23,000; loan interest 19,500

In 2027 that is about C$1.42M of spending, against C$0.15M of gross profit from five pilot installs and C$60,000 of IRAP support.

What the round delivers.

- Canadian-marked heaters and an electrical field-evaluation path before the first install, a stamped seismic base and a reusable permit drawing set.
- A demo Lodge and a Fraser Valley workshop running by mid-2027.
- 5 paid installs and 3 lighthouse references by the end of 2027.
- 19 buildings and a Toronto pipeline by the end of 2028.
- Hardware gross margin of 34% or more in 2028 and 40% or more in 2029, with zero safety incidents.

Why raise now rather than after revenue. Certification, the seismic base and the permit package must exist before the first paid install, and a demo Lodge is the only way to sell a sauna to an owner who has never sat in one. These are fixed costs the round covers once; after that, each install's 50% deposit pays for its materials.

Roadmap and Launch Plan

The launch runs in six phases, from set-up in November 2026 to break-even in 2029, with four decision gates where the evidence decides whether we go on, change the offer or slow down.

> *Chart in the editable original (claude.ai). Data: 08-launch-plan/launch-plan.md sections 3.2 and 3.3 · six phases and four decision gates, Nov 2026 to 2029.*

Phase	When	Main steps	Cost	Done when
0. Set up and validate	Nov 2026 to Jan 2027	Incorporate; trademark; advisers; 30–40 customer meetings; concept engineering; code consultant review; bench-and-glass mock-up; PST ruling request; IRAP call	Pre-seed C$150,000	3 signed letters of intent (at least one hotel and one rental owner); an engineered base concept with a cost; a confirmed certification path
1. Raise the seed	Dec 2026 to Mar 2027	Finish the deck and model; register as a BC Eligible Business Corporation; pitch 30–40 angels and funds; term sheet; close; apply for the equipment loan	Legal C$15,000 (in the pre-seed)	C$2.0M in the bank; loan approved
2. Engineer, certify and build the demo	Jan to Jun 2027	Hire the head of engineering and the sales lead; lease and fit out the workshop; detailed design for Canada; order Canadian-marked heaters and tinted glass; build and heat-test the demo Lodge; electrical field evaluation; insurance; white-label booking platform	C$665,000 one-time plus running costs	Demo Lodge passes inspection and heat test; permit drawing set ready; first two contracts signed with deposits
3. First five installs	Jul to Dec 2027	Permits in Vancouver and Victoria; strata or owner approvals; install 2 in Q3 and 3 in Q4; launch Vantage Care; collect usage data; publish case studies	Covered by deposits and the seed	5 suites live, zero safety incidents, at least 3 references willing to take calls
4. Repeat and open Toronto	2028	14 installs; Toronto business development from Q2; Ontario legal opinion on condo approvals; Ontario electrical interpretation of the 1-hour timer; truck freight to Toronto; first SR&ED refund	Running costs; gross profit from installs	19 buildings live; gross margin 34% or better; a 2029 pipeline of 20+ qualified buildings

Phase	When	Main steps	Cost	Done when
5. Scale and break even	2029 onward	Toronto operations lead; 8,000 sq ft workshop; CSA A277 factory certification and module listing; an optional growth round only to speed up Toronto	From operations	EBITDA-positive in 2029; 43 buildings live by the end of 2029

Decision gates.

- **End of January 2027:** fewer than three letters of intent means we change the offer before raising, for example by leading with the hotel revenue-share or with the Perch only.
- **End of June 2027:** if the demo Lodge costs more than C$130,000 to build, we redesign the panels before taking more orders.
- **End of 2027:** if fewer than three of the five pilots would buy again or refer us, we pause Toronto and fix the product and service first.
- **Mid-2028:** if gross margin is below 30%, we raise prices or cut cost before hiring for Toronto.

The first 30 days.

1. Run a trademark and corporate-name search for "Vantage Sauna" and pick a backup.
2. Incorporate a Canadian-controlled private corporation in BC, open a business bank account and register for GST.
3. Hire a startup lawyer and an accountant who files SR&ED claims, on fixed fees.
4. Book 30 discovery meetings: 10 hotel general managers and owners in Vancouver and Victoria, 10 rental-tower owners and asset managers, 5 strata management firms and 5 developers of new rental and hotel projects.
5. Engage a BC structural engineer for the seismic anchorage concept and an electrical engineer for the 208 V and 600 V design.
6. Call NRC IRAP to meet an Industrial Technology Advisor, and check Futurpreneur eligibility.
7. Request a written BC PST ruling on whether a suite is equipment or an improvement to the building.

Risks and Mitigations

The risks that could stop Vantage are regulatory and structural first (permits, certification, seismic and fire rules), safety second and sales third. Each has a mitigation built into the plan and the budget.

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
Permits and owner votes take longer than planned	Each month of delay pushes revenue back and uses cash	Quote 12–20 weeks (Summit 16–26) and keep the cash cushion; sell to rental owners and hotels first because one person decides; one reusable permit drawing set
Certification surprises	A heater without a Canadian mark cannot be installed, and an inspector can reject the module	Use heaters that already carry a cETLus, cULus or CSA mark and collect the certificate numbers; get the electrical inspector's view on the demo Lodge before the first install; C$70,000 budgeted for certification
Seismic anchors and roof warranties	Anchors through the roof raise site cost and worry owners about leaks	Price anchors as site preparation (C$8,000–15,000); a roofing partner flashes them under the existing roof warranty; a ballasted base where Toronto sites allow it
Roofs that cannot take the load	Roofs not rated for occupancy (4.8 kPa) shrink the market and lengthen sales	Desktop check before any site visit; the base carries loads to beams and columns; newer towers first; reinforcement quoted as site preparation
Fire rules in noncombustible towers	Wood cladding, wood ceilings or an extra storey in the height count can block a permit	Noncombustible wood-look cladding option; tested or fire-retardant ceiling boards; sprinkler-ready module; a code consultant's opinion before selling to 4–6 storey wood buildings
Ontario's 1-hour no-override timer	Booking features that extend a session would break the rule	Hard-wired 1-hour timer outside the app's control; written interpretations from ESA, Vancouver and Victoria on app-started cycles
A safety incident	One burn, slip or heat-related injury would damage the brand and raise insurance costs	Session timers, 90 °C cap, emergency stop, occupancy sensor, signage, access only for booked users, Care inspection records, products and completed-operations cover
Condo votes fail	BC needs 3/4 of the votes cast; Ontario needs 66⅔% of all units when the cost exceeds 10% of the budget	Lead with rentals and hotels; information-session kits and sample resolutions; keep a Perch or Lodge under the 10% line in Toronto towers of about 300+ units; a legal opinion on a Vantage-owned, pay-per-use model
Sales tax adds cost	Condos and long-term landlords cannot recover GST/HST, and BC PST	A written BC PST ruling before quoting in BC; quote these customers with tax shown; the Flex lease spreads

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
	could apply to the whole contract	the cost
Tariffs and exchange rates	Imported steel derivative goods carry a 25% surtax, some US goods face counter-tariffs, and some components are priced in US dollars or euros	Canadian steel, EU-made heaters (duty-free), quarterly price reviews, add-ons priced separately
Demand is weaker than planned	The research's conservative case is 81 buildings by 2031, not 122	A C$2.0M seed rather than the minimum; the seed lasts through 2029 in the downside case; the 2029–2030 hires wait
Night-time privacy with tinted glass	The reflective glass works in reverse after dark	A dim night lighting scene and an optional interior blind
Key-person and hiring risk	The plan depends on three hires in 2027	Recruiting starts before the round closes; paid advisers cover engineering and code in the interim; an option pool reserved for the first hires

Appendix

A. Technical spec sheet

Item	Perch	Lodge	Summit
Electrical supply	208 V three-phase; the 10.5 kW heater draws about 29 A, plus lighting and controls	208 V three-phase; 18 kW, about 50 A	208 V three-phase; 2 × 12 kW, about 67 A, plus the plunge chiller and pumps
600 V buildings	600 V to 208Y/120 V transformer kit, about 30 kVA (est.)	About 30 kVA (est.)	About 45 kVA (est.)
Heater certification	Canadian mark (cETLus, cULus or CSA) to CSA C22.2 No. 164-18; hard-wired 1-hour timer, no override	Same	Same
Effective heated volume (with glass allowance)	\~16 m³	\~25 m³	\~37 m³
Water and drain	Floor drain to the roof drain; no supply needed	Water supply for the indoor shower in the vestibule; drain	Water supply for the outdoor shower and the 1,200 L plunge; drain
Clear roof area needed	About 5 × 6 m including access and clearances	About 6 × 8 m	About 8 × 12 m including the terrace
Structural design basis	Occupied roof rated 4.8 kPa; \~2,300 kg carried to beams and columns; 4–8 engineered anchors in BC, ballast in Toronto where the site is SC1 or SC2	Same; \~4,500 kg	Same; \~8,000 kg module plus \~1,900 kg plunge over primary structure
Module roof	2.0 kPa snow plus drift; wind to NBC 4.1.7	Same	Same
Delivery	Flat-pack kit by elevator (panels up to 2.0 × 1.1 m, pieces under 120 kg) or one craneable module	Same	Craneable module plus deck and plunge
Door and access	850 mm clear door (900 mm leaf); level landing	Same; 1,500 mm turning space in the hot room	Same
Interior temperature	70–90 °C, capped at 90 °C	Same	Same; plunge 4–10 °C

Item	Perch	Lodge	Summit
Contract to first session	12–20 weeks	12–20 weeks	16–26 weeks

B. Building-owner one-pager

Vantage Sauna Co.: the amenity above everything. We design, build and install rooftop sauna suites for rental towers, business apartments, hotels and condos in Vancouver, Victoria and Toronto. One contract, one from-price, 12–20 weeks from signature to first session.

- **What you get:** a factory-built, all-electric sauna suite seating 4 to 14 people, with both bench tiers facing a full-length, privacy-tinted glass front so every seat has a view. The Lodge adds a changing vestibule with an indoor shower; the Summit adds a changing room, a cold plunge and an outdoor shower. A smart lock and booking app for residents or guests, and a service plan that keeps it running.
- **What it costs:** from C$99,000 (Perch), C$179,000 (Lodge) or C$329,000 (Summit) installed, before tax, or from C$2,150, C$3,850 or C$6,800 a month on Vantage Flex with service and software included. Site preparation, such as BC seismic anchors (C$8,000–15,000) or a transformer kit for 600 V buildings (C$10,000–25,000), is quoted separately.
- **What we handle:** structural and seismic design with a licensed engineer, electrical design, permits, the factory build, elevator or crane delivery, installation, commissioning, staff training and the launch event. For stratas and condos we supply an information-session kit and sample resolutions.
- **What you provide:** a clear roof area, a barrier-free route and an exit to the roof, an electrical service with capacity (or a quoted upgrade), a roof drain within reach, and owner or council approval.
- **Next step:** a free site assessment from your roof plans. We tell you which model fits, what it costs and when it can be live.

C. Frequently asked questions from building owners

Will my roof take the weight? Our suites are designed for occupied roofs rated 4.8 kPa, the code load for roofs people gather on, and the steel base carries the weight to the building's beams and columns. A licensed structural engineer reviews every site before we quote. If your roof is rated lower, we quote the reinforcement as site preparation.

Do you penetrate the roof? In Vancouver and Victoria, yes: seismic rules require the base to be bolted to the structure, so we use 4–8 engineered anchors that a roofer flashes under your roof warranty. In Toronto, where the site allows, the base sits on ballast and load-spreading pads with no penetrations.

What about fire code and insurance? The heater is electric and carries a Canadian certification mark, the walls use non-combustible insulation and sheathing, the roof is steel, and the interior is capped at 90 °C. For noncombustible towers we offer a noncombustible cladding and tested ceiling boards, and the module

is sprinkler-ready. We carry products and completed-operations liability and name you as additional insured; your own liability cover treats the sauna like a gym or pool.

How long does it take? 12–20 weeks from contract to first session for Perch and Lodge, and 16–26 weeks for Summit, including permits and owner votes. On-site work is one to six days.

Who maintains it? Vantage Care: quarterly inspections, heater stones, bench refinishing, parts and 24-hour support, from C$450 a month.

How do residents or guests book? Through the Vantage Access app. The smart lock opens only for a booked session. Each session is one heater cycle of at most one hour, which the app cannot extend. The building sets hours, age rules and, for hotels, prices.

Can a hotel charge for it? Yes. Fairmont Pacific Rim in Vancouver sells C$40 sessions, and local sauna studios charge C$35–58. Hotels can bill through their own systems or through Vantage Access, or join the revenue-share pilot.

What if our building has only 600 V power? Sauna heaters for Canada are rated 300 V or less, so we add a 600 V to 208Y/120 V transformer kit, quoted as site preparation at about C$10,000–25,000. Buildings with 120/208 V service usually need only a new circuit to the roof.

How does a strata or condo approve it? In BC, at one general meeting with two 3/4 votes: one to approve the change and one to fund it. In Ontario, if the cost is under 10% of the annual budget the board can proceed after notice to owners; above that, owners of 66⅔% of all units must vote yes. We prepare the information session and the resolutions.

Is sales tax included? No. Prices exclude GST, PST and HST. Hotels recover GST/HST; condos and long-term rental landlords generally cannot, so we show the tax on their quotes.

D. Glossary

- **ACV:** average contract value, the blended hardware price of an installed suite including add-ons (C$181,500).
- **BCBC, VBBL, OBC, NBC:** the BC Building Code 2024, the Vancouver Building By-law 2025, the Ontario Building Code 2024, and the National Building Code 2020 they are built on.
- **CEC:** the Canadian Electrical Code (CSA C22.1), adopted as the BC Electrical Code and the Ontario Electrical Safety Code.
- **CSA C22.2 No. 164:** the Canadian safety standard for electric sauna heaters, including a heater combined with a factory-built room.
- **cETLus, cULus, CSA:** certification marks accepted in Canada; a US-only ETL or UL mark is not.
- **CSA A277:** the certification procedure for factory-built buildings, modules and panels.
- **CSA B651:** the Canadian accessible-design standard referenced by both provincial building codes.

- **CSBFP:** the Canada Small Business Financing Program, which guarantees bank loans for equipment and leaseholds.
- **NRC IRAP and SR&ED:** federal R&D support: IRAP contributions toward engineering salaries, and the 35% refundable SR&ED tax credit.
- **EBC:** a BC Eligible Business Corporation, whose investors get a 30% BC tax credit.
- **SC1 to SC4:** seismic categories in the NBC; Vancouver and Victoria are SC4.
- **kPa:** kilopascals, the unit for roof load ratings (4.8 kPa for occupied roofs).
- **Flat-pack:** the suite delivered as panels sized for an elevator and assembled on the roof.
- **GST, PST, HST:** the federal Goods and Services Tax (5%), BC's Provincial Sales Tax (7%) and Ontario's Harmonized Sales Tax (13%).
- **Strata, condo corporation:** the owners' corporation of a condo building in BC and in Ontario.
- **Vantage Access:** the booking, access-control and analytics software, C$300 a month per building.
- **Vantage Care:** the service plan, C$450–1,150 a month by model.
- **Vantage Flex:** the 84-month lease offered through a Canadian finance partner.